

SYMPOSIUM 2.0

Permanent Multi-Year Symposium Platform — V2

Creative Codex | Department of CSE | SIET, Tumakuru

Project Documentation for the Development Team — V2 Update

Status: V2 build complete, verified — pending team/faculty review and deployment

1. What Changed Since V1

The original onboarding brief described a plan. This update describes what was actually built. The biggest change: **registration now happens entirely on our own website**, not through an external Google Form. Participants fill in a form specific to the event they're registering for, pay via UPI (scanning a QR code the admin uploads, with the amount already set), upload a screenshot of the payment, and get an instant registration ID and receipt.

Several new pages were also added beyond the original plan: Travel & Accommodation info, a Judges/Mentors page (kept a surprise until the event itself, on purpose), a Code of Conduct page, and participant testimonials.

2. The Simplest Way to Understand V2

Same two-part structure as before — a Public Website and a private Admin Panel — but the Admin Panel now has real teeth. Whoever is admin can literally turn registration on or off for any single event, upload that event's payment QR code, decide exactly what information to collect (name, email, USN, whatever's needed — added one field at a time, no coding), and watch real registrations come in, searchable and exportable to Excel.

3. How Registration Actually Works Now

For each event, the admin sets up:

- Whether registration is Open, Coming Soon, Paused, Closed, or Full — the public page always shows the true current state, never a broken or misleading link.
- Minimum and maximum team size.
- The registration fee and a UPI QR code image (generated by the faculty coordinator with the amount already baked in — money goes straight to the faculty account, the website only ever sees a screenshot as proof of payment).
- Exactly which questions to ask — name, email, college, USN, whatever the team decides — added one at a time in the admin panel. Nothing is hardcoded, so next year's events can have a completely different set of questions without anyone touching code.

When someone registers, they get a unique registration ID immediately (like `SYM2-HACK-0001`), and can print or download their receipt. The admin can then mark each registration as "Paid" once they've checked the payment screenshot, search through registrations, spot possible duplicate sign-ups (flagged, never auto-blocked, since registering for more than one event is completely normal), and export everything to a real Excel file.

4. What This Website Still Will NOT Do

Unchanged from the original plan, and confirmed still out of scope after the V2 build: no participant login accounts beyond the one-time registration form itself, no online payment gateway (manual UPI + screenshot instead), no automatic certificate generation, no live chat or AI chatbot, no forums, no attendance tracking or judging/scoring system, no dedicated mobile app.

5. Real Problems Found and Fixed Along the Way

Worth recording honestly, since it's useful for whoever maintains this next: building V2 surfaced a handful of genuine bugs, all caught through deliberate testing rather than assumed away, and all fixed before this was handed over:

- A page (the registration form itself) was initially missing its footer entirely — caught by checking every page systematically, not just the ones that seemed likely to have problems.
- A filtering bug in the shared backend code meant that data for one event could sometimes get mixed up with another event's data — caught by testing with more than one event in the database at once, which the original testing hadn't done.
- Three different Excel-export tools were tried before finding one with no known security vulnerabilities in its own code — a reminder to always check, not just trust that a popular library is automatically safe.

6. Where We Are Right Now

- **Build:** complete and verified — every page, the full backend, and the admin panel have been tested against a real running

database, not just written and assumed to work.

- **Content:** still placeholder for this year's specific events, dates, judges, and sponsors — real content goes in once the team finalises those details.
- **Hosting:** planned (GitHub Pages for the site, Render or Railway for the backend and database) but not yet actually deployed.
- **Review:** this build is meant to be reviewed by the team and faculty before it goes live — nothing has been made public yet.

7. Suggested Next Steps

1. Get the whole team to actually run the project locally (`npm install` , `npm run dev`) and click through it.
2. Take it to faculty/seniors for review, framed clearly as "structure and functionality" review since the visual design has already gone through its own decision process.
3. Once approved, start filling in real content: this year's actual events, dates, coordinator names, and set up each event's registration (fields, fee, QR code) in the admin panel.
4. Choose and set up hosting (Render or Railway for the backend, following the existing Hosting Guide).
5. Deploy, test the live site end-to-end one more time, then go live.